

HERB FILE 001 · FREE CARD · RECTO

He picked the right tree for completely the wrong reason.

In 1763 an English parson chose willow bark because willow grows in wet ground and fevers came from wet ground. The logic was worthless. The bark was not.



PLATE RESERVE — NOT GENERATED

Plate 1 — *Salix* specimen

Bough, six to nine lanceolate leaves, two catkins, bark section at 2x scale. Charcoal and umber line, single accent on the catkins only. Earth-side: no barrier.

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DOCUMENTED

Edward Stone gave willow bark to around fifty people with agues and wrote it up for the Royal Society in 1763.

TRADITION

He chose it by the doctrine of signatures — the belief that a plant growing where an illness comes from carries its answer.

MODERN SCIENCE

Willow bark holds salicin, and the line runs from there to aspirin — but willow bark is still not aspirin.

UNKNOWN

Whether the doses people actually took were ever near enough to matter. No dose records survive.

THE OPEN QUESTION

If the reasoning was wrong, why did the plant work?

A HISTORY FILE. NOT HEALTH ADVICE. NOT A RECOMMENDATION TO TAKE ANYTHING.

Willow bark is not aspirin.

This is the page that protects the reader, so it is placed before anything that could be mistaken for encouragement. The chemistry line from bark to drug is real and dated. It does not run backwards: the existence of a manufactured drug derived from a plant is not evidence about the plant as people actually used it.

■ DOCUMENTED

Acetylsalicylic acid irreversibly acetylates COX-1 in platelets. The salicylate route from willow does not act on platelets in the same way, so the two are not interchangeable.

■ DOCUMENTED

Salicin content varies widely between *Salix* species and with harvest conditions, so 'willow bark' is not one consistent material.

■■■■ UNKNOWN

Whether any raw bark preparation reproduces results seen in studied standardised extracts. Not established.

THYLORA READS IT THIS WAY

The interesting thing is not that the old use was vindicated. It is that it was vindicated sideways — the plant led to a drug that works differently from the plant. That gap is where most plant writing quietly cheats.

NO DOSING. NO SAFETY CLEARANCE. NO TREATMENT CLAIM. DOCUMENTED RISK SIGNALS APPEAR ON PAGE 15.

PREVIEW — NOT ACTIVATED, NOT PUBLISHED, NOT SCHEDULED · RIGHTS: THYLORA · IMAGERY: NONE GENERATED

Register index

1763 DOCUMENTED

1828 DOCUMENTED

1838 DOCUMENTED

1897 CONTESTED

1971 DOCUMENTED

— UNKNOWN

PLATE RESERVE — NOT
GENERATED

Plate 2 detail

*Final station of
the bark-to-
molecule line:
where the plant
stops and the
manufactured
drug begins.*

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WEIGHT. SOLID/HEAVY =
DOCUMENTED. DOTTED/LIGHT =
UNKNOWN.